MODULE 01 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Team & Foundations

Why do the best teams beat the best ideas?

COURSE PATH

00 | 01 | 02 | 03 | 04 | 05 | 06 | 07 | 08 | 09 | 10 | 11 | 12

COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 01-team-foundations
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M01_Lecture_Team-Foundations.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

From alone to a team

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

Three problem hypotheses
Kickoff (M00)

Conversations with named people
Kickoff (M00)

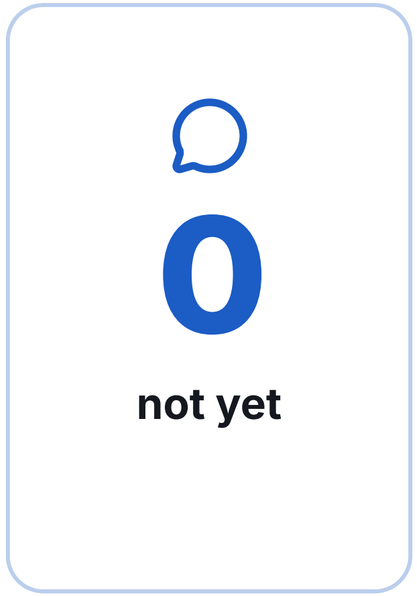
A one-minute problem pitch
Kickoff (M00)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

How many named people did you talk to?

Hands up for your band. One click on the band per hand

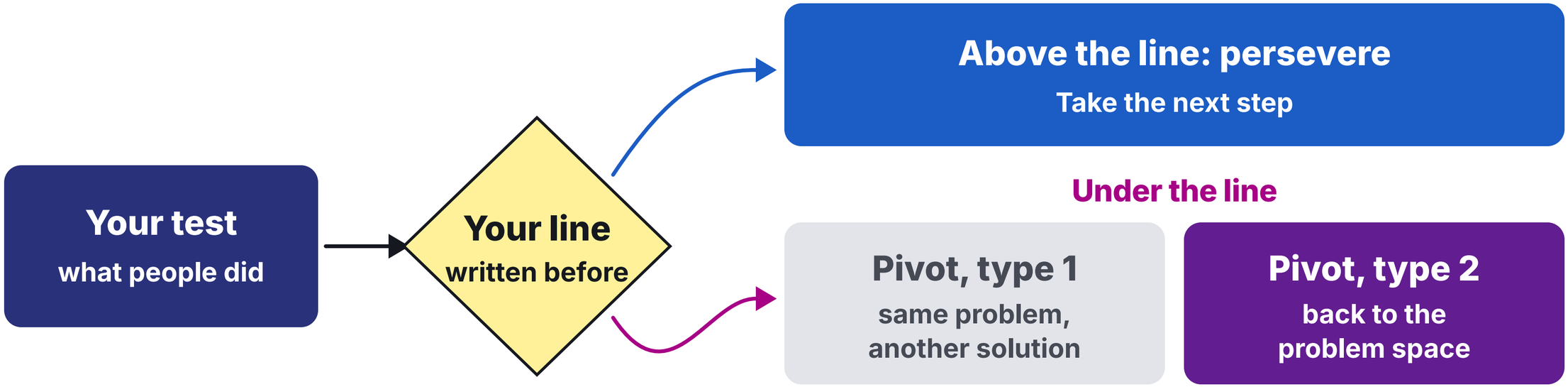


2:00

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Your hypothesis survived its kill line, or you test the next one. Both are progress



Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision

FRAMEWORK Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Three questions, every session

1

User interactions?

What did you learn?

2

New revenue?

Why did they pay?

3

Shipped?

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

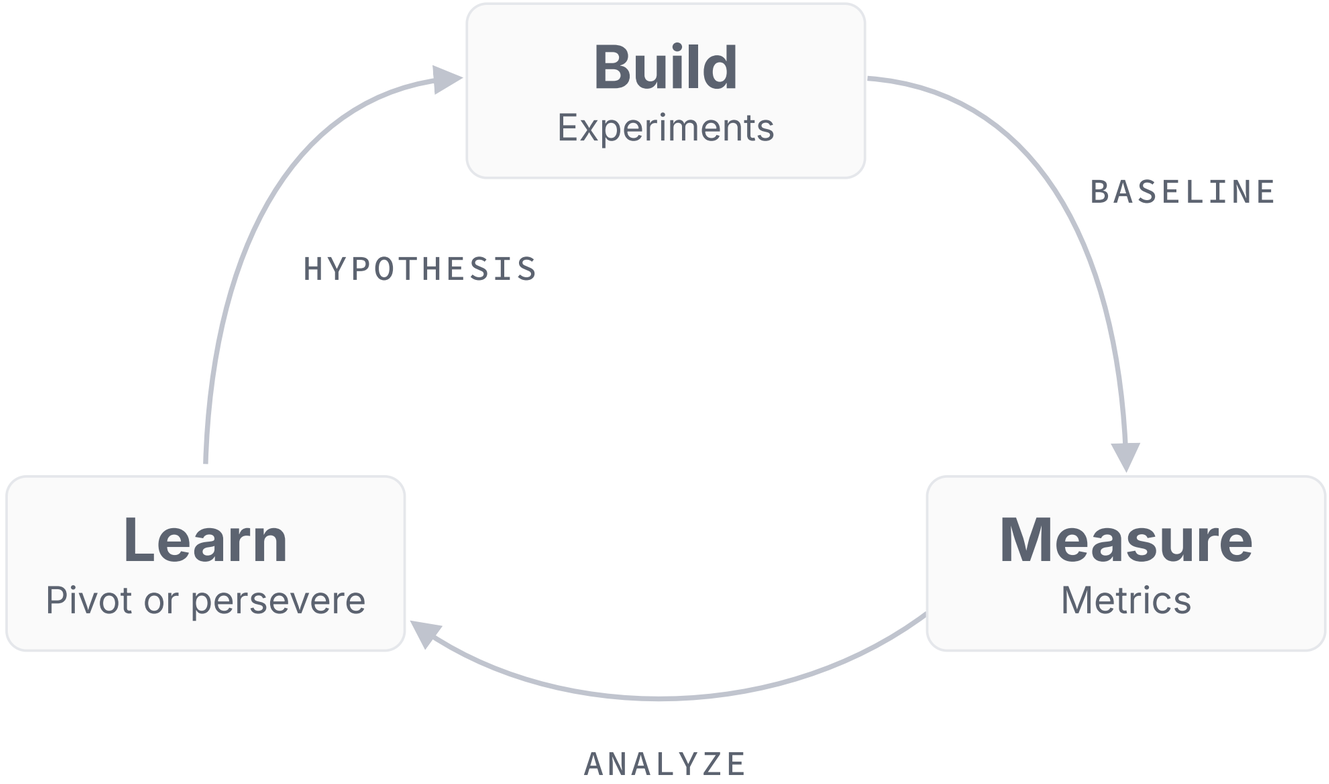
You wrote hypotheses and met named people, and today you find the team to test them.

01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Aim it: startup or small business**
04 **Staff it: why teams matter**
05 **Commit to it: a long-term relationship**
06 **Keep it honest: feedback and candor**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: find your team and test the fit
09 Case discussion

PREVIOUSLY · KICKOFF (M00)

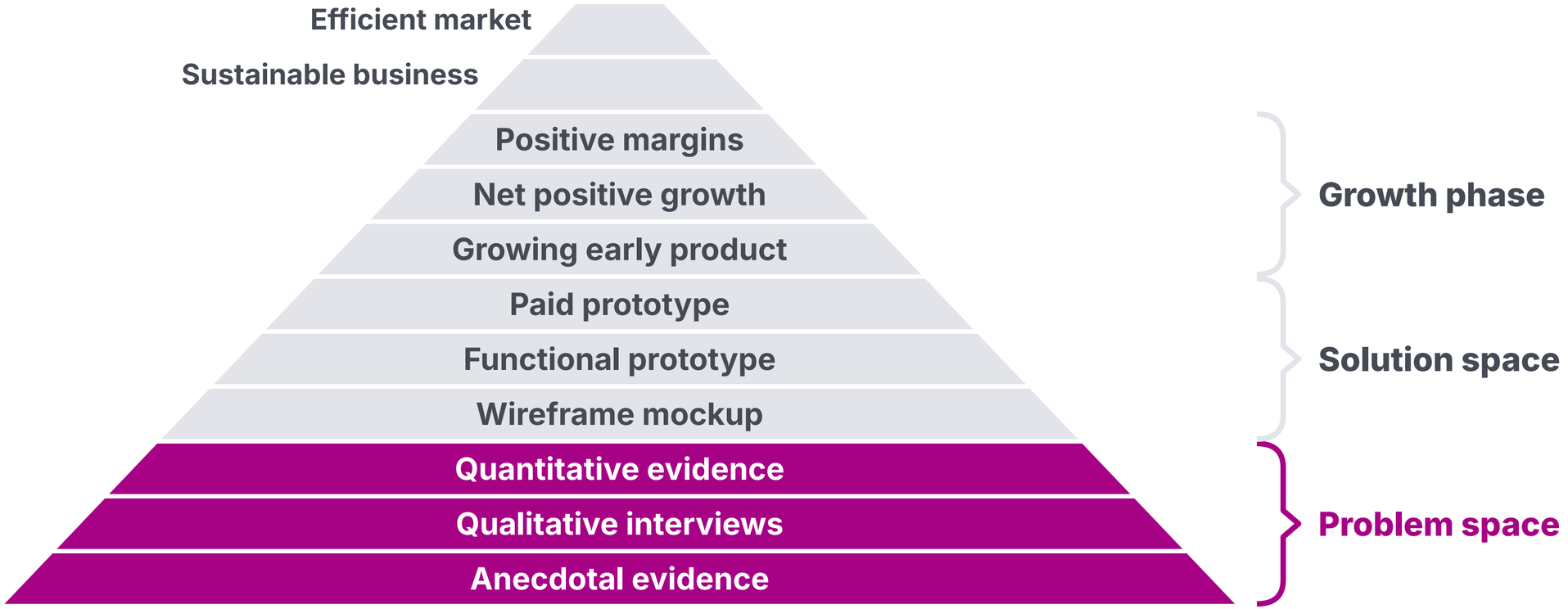
Your idea is a hypothesis

Testing it is a team sport



PREVIOUSLY · KICKOFF (M00)

Still in the problem space. Who are your mates?



TODAY · WHERE WE ARE

You are trained for it. Today you find your team

The next three sessions take the third pillar

✓ You are trained | Today | Next three sessions | By Finding ideas (M02)

Pillar 1

Learn what it takes

How do I do it?

This course trains you

Pillar 2

Find a team

Who will be my mates?

Today

Pillar 3

Discover a problem

- Finding ideas (M02)
- Problem space (M03)
- Validating problems (M04)

Outcomes

Team committed for full-time work

All necessary disciplines covered

Agreement on the hard and soft facts about funding

Agreement on one problem space

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

Your presentations

Teams show where they are in three minutes, and everyone else pitches a problem worth years.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

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YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

3:00

Facts

Statistics or research

Who has the problem?

With sources

12 Numbers

Usage or surveys

Talks held, next steps

The cost people named

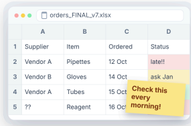
Quotes

Interviews

The 2 or 3 that changed a hypothesis

Roles, not names

Images



Screenshots or users

The workaround

If someone showed it

Target vs. actual · which hypothesis survived?

What did you do?

What did you learn?

How can we help?

Whom do you want to build with?

ILLUSTRATIVE The workaround screen is prototyped for this deck.

NO TEAM YET?

Pitch the problem you would spend years on

1 minute

Who has the problem?

Cost what does it cost them?

Quote one thing you heard

Gap the skill you are missing

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

Aim it: startup or small business

Decide what you are building, a company designed to grow fast or one designed for profit.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Aim it: startup or small business**

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INPUT 1 OF 4 · AIM IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Before you team up: what are you building?

1

What separates a startup from a small business?

2

Why do investors care?

3

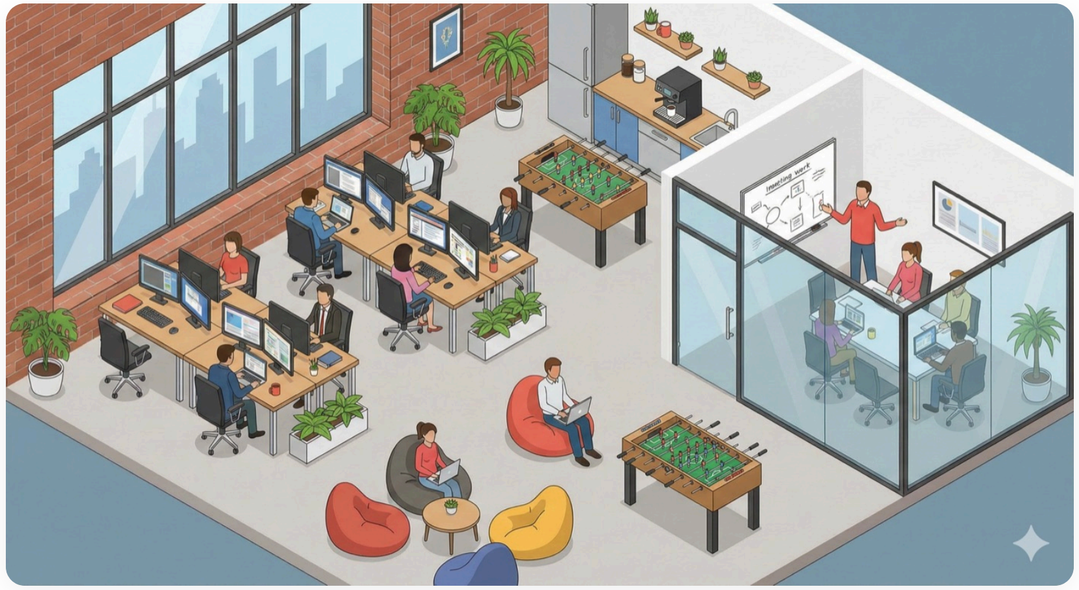
Which number do you optimise?

FIRST QUESTION · WHAT ARE YOU BUILDING TOGETHER?

“We're basically a startup.” Seriously?

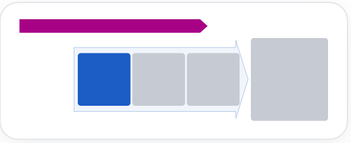
Both are real companies. Only one is built to grow

Startup



Small business





THE DIFFERENCE IS GROWTH

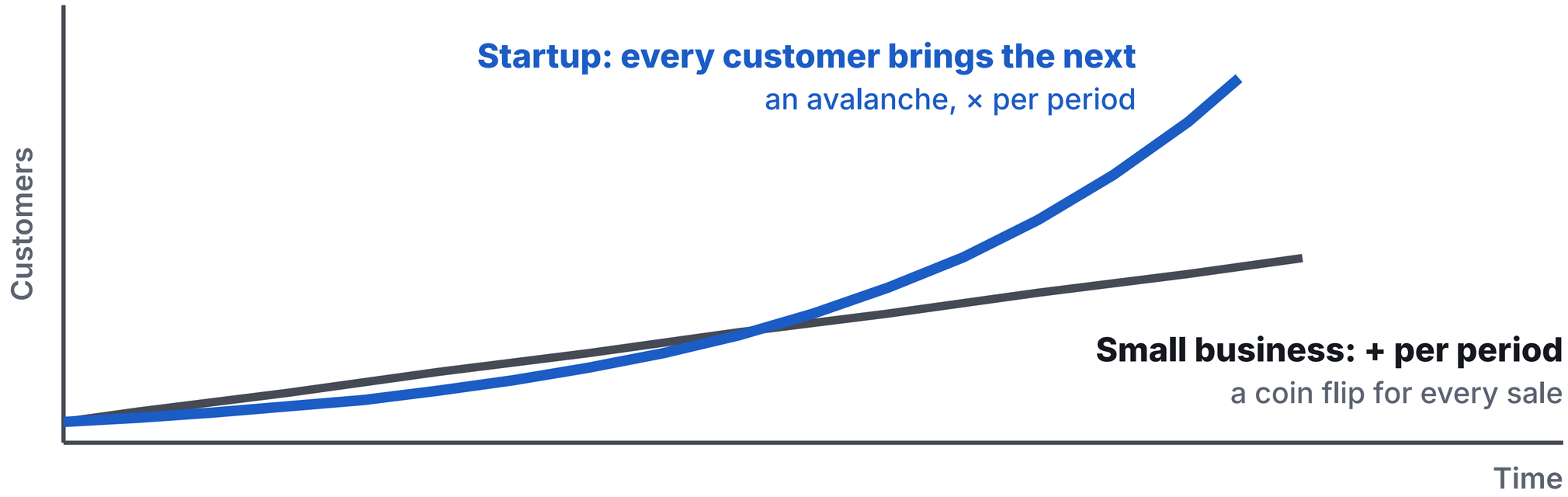
A startup optimises growth. A small business, profit

Startup = growth	**Small business = profit**
% more revenue or customers per week	revenue - expenses
Can run at a loss, so banks won't lend	Profit from assets, so banks will lend
Large user bases, high multiples	Steady returns, lower multiples

> TAKEAWAY **Never either-or. Startups should be efficient too. It is about the core metric**

THE MATHS · 1 OF 3 · AVALANCHE OR COIN FLIP

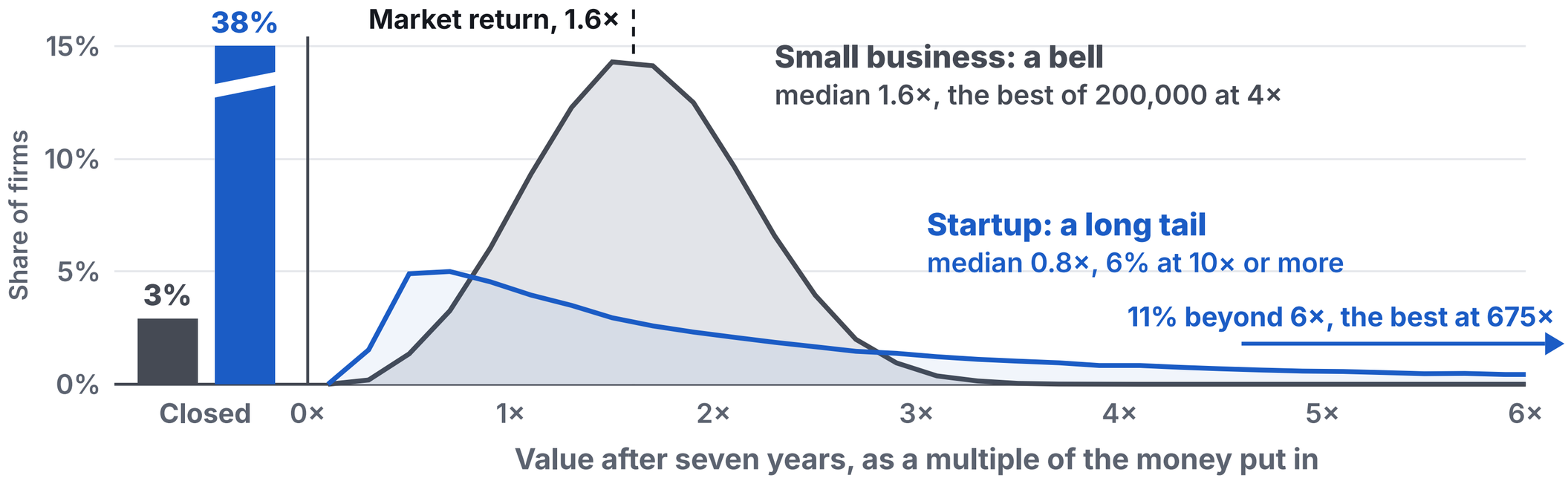
Each customer brings the next, or each sale starts from zero



THE MATHS · 2 OF 3 · WHERE THEY LAND

Small businesses land on a bell, startups on a long tail

200,000 simulated firms of each kind, seven years, one euro in

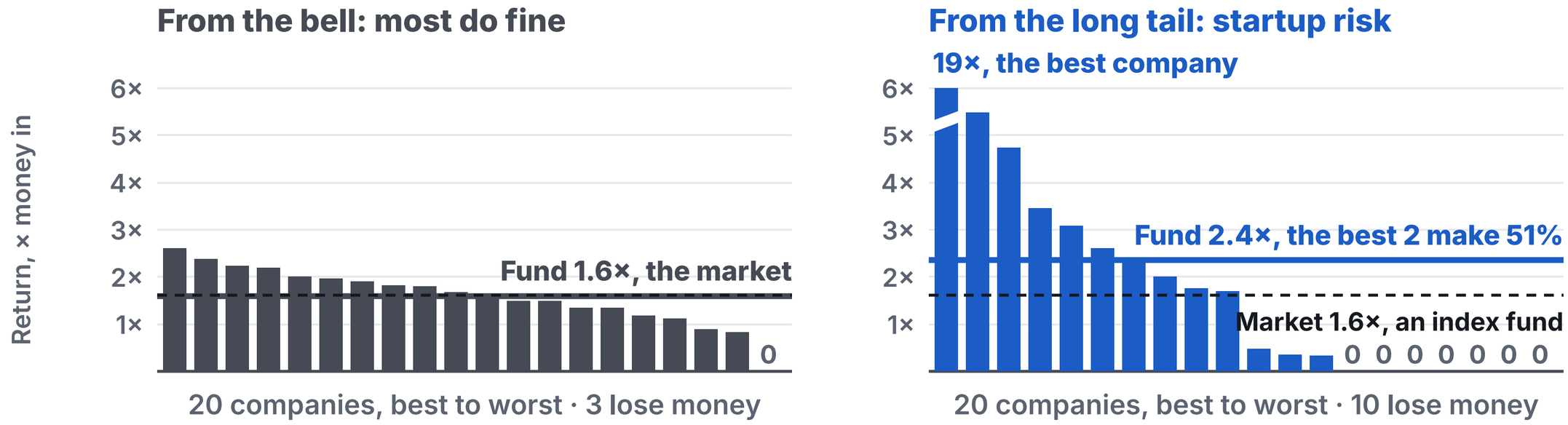


ILLUSTRATIVE Simulation for this course, parameters in the notes. Startup side fitted to Evans (2016).

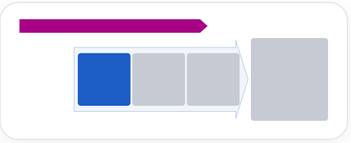
THE MATHS · 3 OF 3 · WHAT INVESTORS BUY

If most did fine, a VC would just own the market

A VC buys startup risk, so it expects most to fail



ILLUSTRATIVE Simulation for this course, one typical fund of 20 out of 10,000. Market return 7% a year.



THE DATA · WHY INVESTORS CARE

Investors fund the tail, not the average

6% of deals made 60% of the returns

Deals that returned 10× or more · share of all deals

6%

What those deals returned · share of all returns

60%

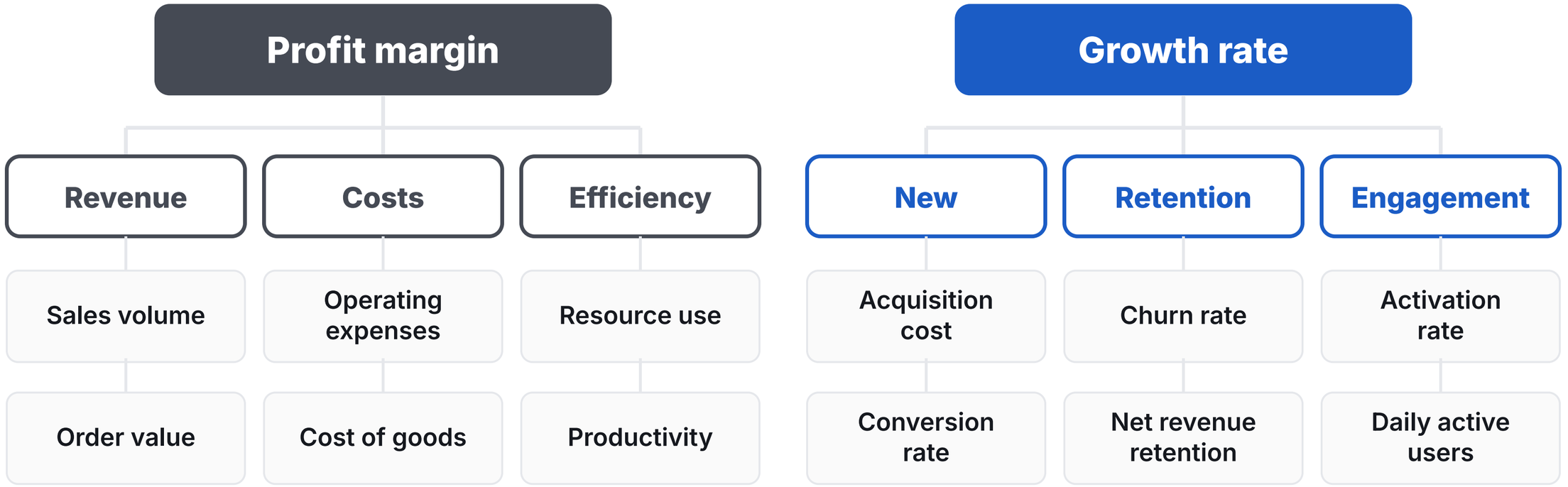
Deals that returned less than they cost · about half

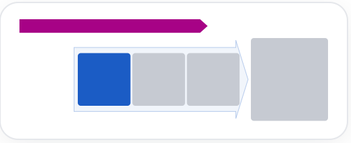
about 50%

DATA Evans, B. (2016). *In praise of failure*. Horsley Bridge data, about 7,000 VC investments, 1985 to 2014. Bars to scale.

KPI TREES

Pick your number, growth rate or profit margin





NOW YOU · ALONE · 2 MINUTES

Which number would you wake up for?

Startup — Growth rate of what, per week?

Small biz — Margin on what, per sale?

How far — Where in ten years?

2:00

OUTPUT

One number, one ambition

INPUT 1 OF 4 · AIM IT · THE ANSWERS

Aim it: decide growth or profit first

1

What separates a startup from a small business?

Growth. A startup optimises growth, a small business profit

2

Why do investors care?

They fund the tail: 6% of deals made 60% of the returns

3

Which number do you optimise?

Growth rate per week for a startup, profit margin for a small business

Staff it: why teams matter

Growth is a team sport, so cover tech, product and sales, not just people like you.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

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INPUT 2 OF 4 · STAFF IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Why build it together?

1

Why not found alone?

2

Which skills must a team cover?

3

Where do gaps come from?

WHY TEAMS MATTER

It's dangerous to go alone

Founding is hard enough. Share the load



Alone: all of it, every day



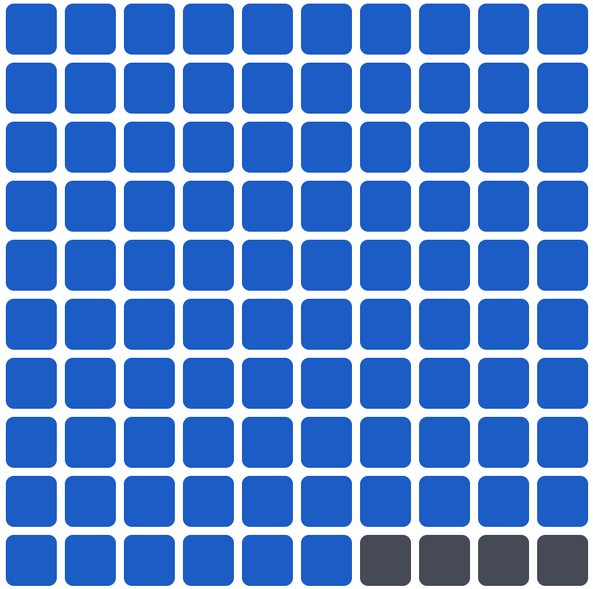
Together: one short stack each

Title after the line in *The Legend of Zelda* (Nintendo, 1986).

THE EVIDENCE

96 of YC's top 100 had a co-founder

Solo founders start 30% of companies, get 14.7% of the cash

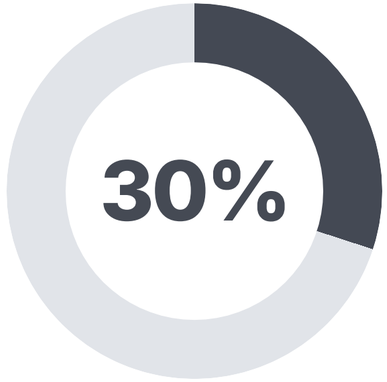


96

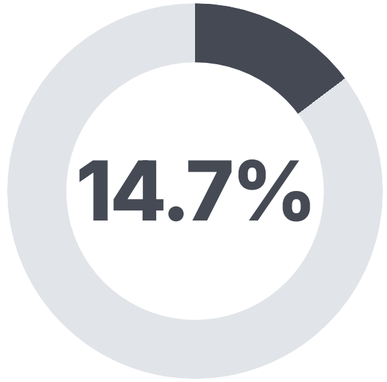
of YC's top 100 came with a co-founder

4 came alone

Solo founders, U.S., 2024



of new startups



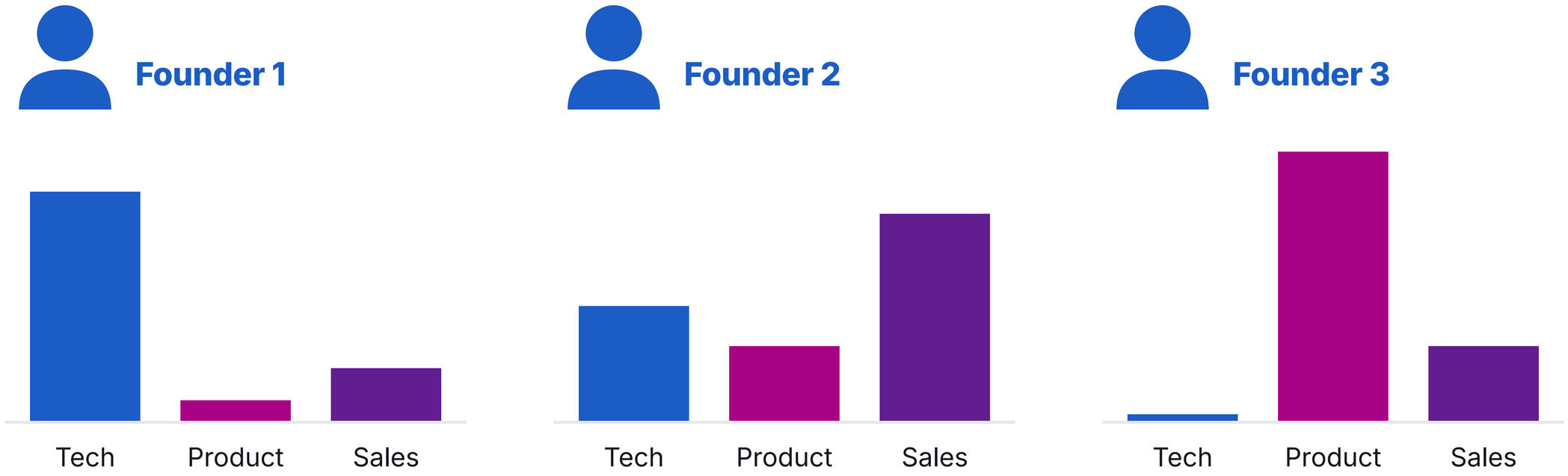
of the money in priced rounds

YC Title: Li, C. (2021). YC co-founder matching. YC blog. Data on solo founders: Walker, P., & Shad, H. (2025). *Solo founders report 2025*. Carta. Waffle and rings to scale.

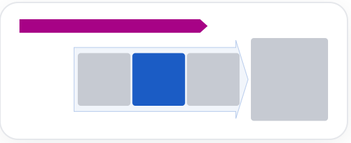
WHAT YOU WANT IN A TEAM · CORNERSTONE

Show you can execute in tech, product and sales

Three founders, three different bars



ILLUSTRATIVE Founder skill bars, heights as Bastian drew them.

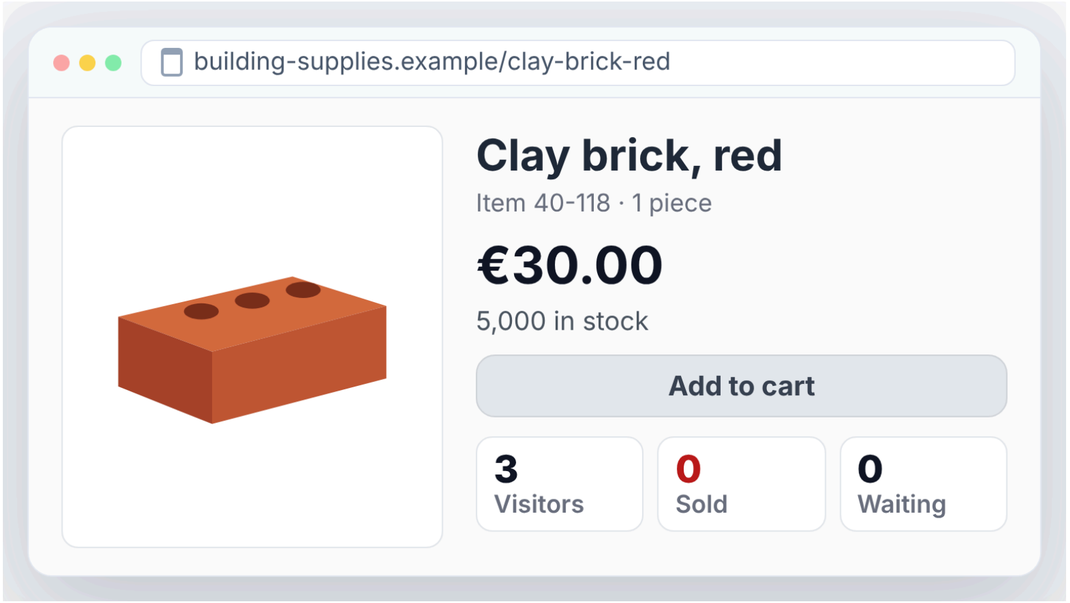


PRODUCT AND SALES

Same brick. Product and sales make the queue

Tech alone is a brick

Tech alone



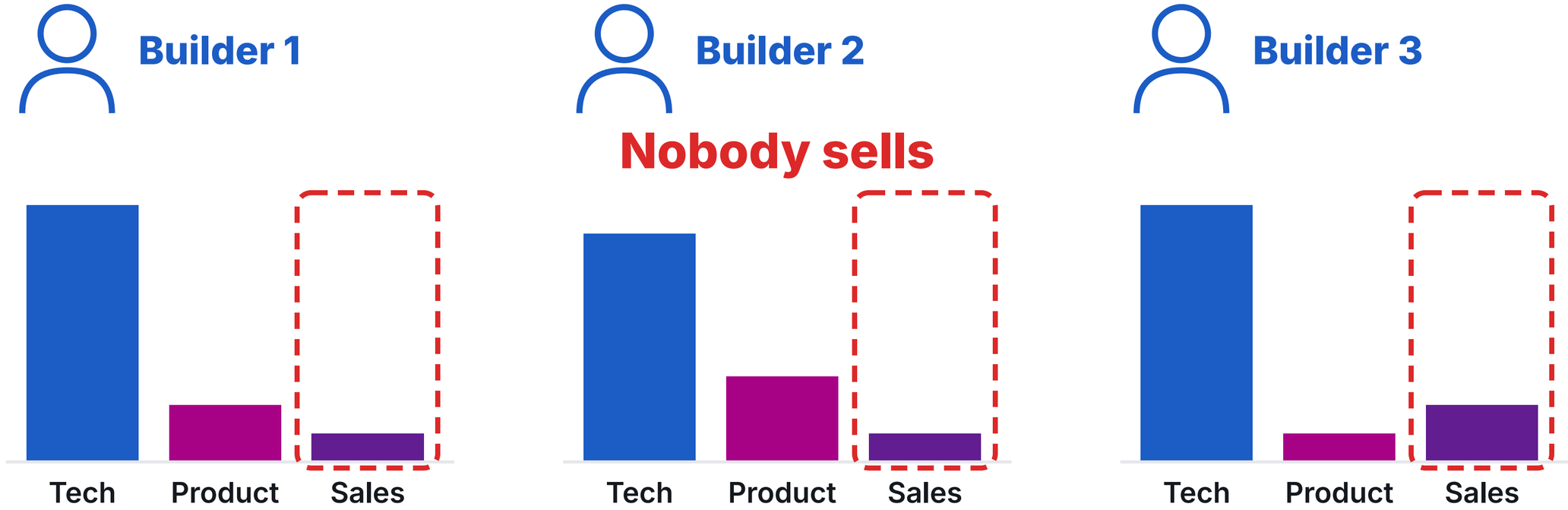
Tech, product and sales



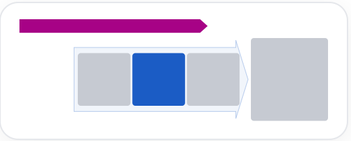
WHO WE PICK

We pick people like us, and get gaps

Similarity and strong ties shape founding teams most



RESEARCH Ruef, M., Aldrich, H. E., & Carter, N. M. (2003). *American Sociological Review*, 68(2). Bars illustrative.



NOW YOU · ALONE · 2 MINUTES

Name your gap

Gap — Which skill stops you building or selling?

Person — Who do you know who has it?

Close — Learn, recruit or pay?

2:00

OUTPUT

One gap, one name

INPUT 2 OF 4 · STAFF IT · THE ANSWERS

Staff it: cover tech, product and sales

1

Why not found alone?

Founding is hard. 96 of YC's top 100 came with a co-founder

2

Which skills must a team cover?

Tech, product and sales, shown in what you have executed

3

Where do gaps come from?

We pick people like us, so nobody sells

Commit to it: a long-term relationship

Find co-founders like customers, test the fit under load and write down who decides what.

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INPUT 3 OF 4 · COMMIT TO IT · THREE QUESTIONS

How do you pick a co-founder?

1

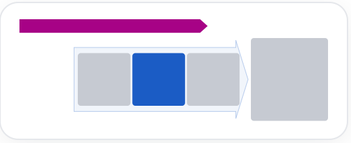
Where do you find co-founders?

2

How do you test the fit?

3

What do you settle before you commit?



FINDING A CO-FOUNDER

Find co-founders like customers, with a pipeline

Choose people you have seen work

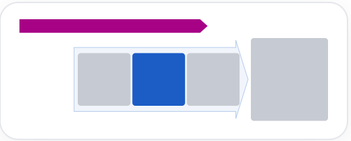
People you have worked with
Projects, theses, jobs, this course

Events and hackathons
Watch them ship under pressure

Programmes and communities
Built to match complementary skills

Online matching
YC Co-Founder Matching

YC YC Co-Founder Matching, over 100K matches, as of October 2026. Taggar, H. (2024). How to find a co-founder. Startup School.

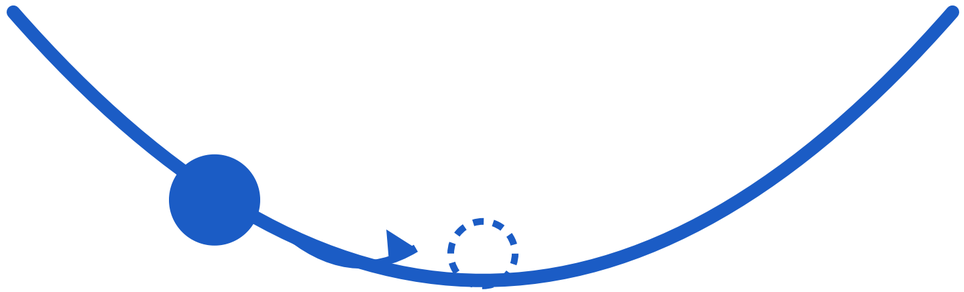


CONVERGENT OR DIVERGENT

After a shock, do you roll back together?

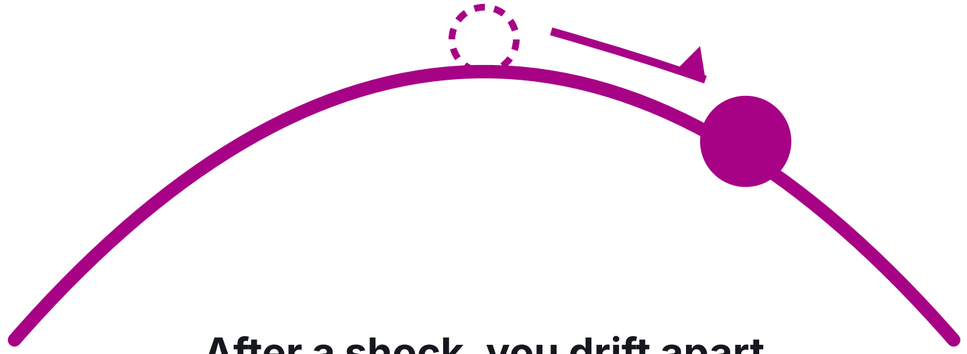
Test it like a lab. Pressure first, then everyday work, not a retreat

Convergent: a valley

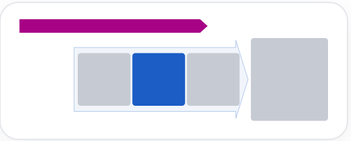


After a shock, everyday work brings you back together

Divergent: a hill



After a shock, you drift apart unless someone pushes it back

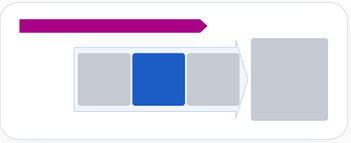


TEST THE FIT

Fit shows under load, not over coffee

Use the days until next time as the trial

Day 1	Days 2 to 6	Day 7	Day 7
Workshop	**Real work**	**Feedback round**	**Confirm**
Six questions, draft agreement	Conversations, two side by side	Situation, behaviour, impact, change	Every founder signs off



BEFORE YOU COMMIT

Ask the hard questions before they get hard

Alone first, then side by side

1 Hours

2 Savings

3 Ambition

4 Role

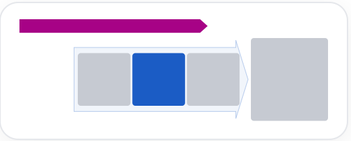
5 Problem

6 Leaving

Instructions

1. Save your own copy of this file.
2. Answer every question alone and honestly, before you see anyone else's answers.
3. Put your answers next to your potential co-founders' answers.
4. Talk through every match and every gap, and ask why, for them and for yourself. Write what you agree into the Team sheet of your Student Toolkit.

How you work	
1	How many hours a week do you want to work, and for how long can you keep that up? Which pace sounds great to you, and which sounds unbearable? Would you work harder in the first year than later?



EQUITY

Settle roles first, shares second

A split every founder feels is fair keeps the team together

1 Roles

Who does what, who decides

2 Commitment

Hours, money, how long

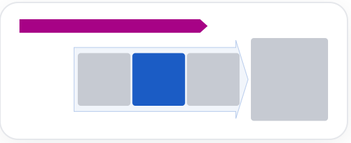
3 Shares

A split every founder feels is fair

Equal splits go with less outside money.

The authors find selection, not cause

RESEARCH Hellmann, T., & Wasserman, N. (2017). *Management Science*, 63(8). Breugst, N., Patzelt, H., & Rathgeber, P. (2015). *Journal of Business Venturing*, 30(1). July lecture slide 21.



WHO DECIDES WHAT

Give two-way decisions one owner

One-way doors together and slowly. Then disagree and commit



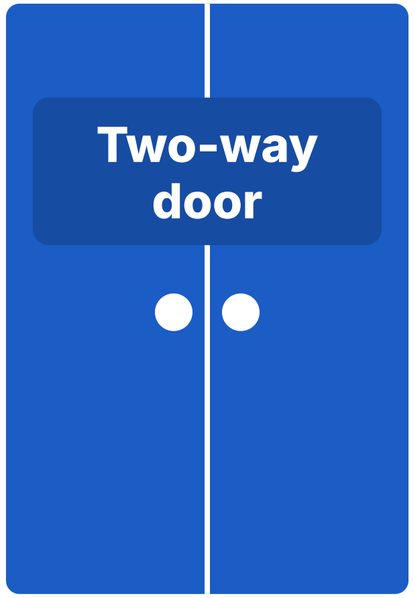
Few decisions

Hard to undo. Decide together, slowly.

Equity, who leaves, startup or not

Most decisions

One owner decides fast



FRAMEWORK Bezos, J. (2016). 2015 letter to shareholders. Bezos, J. (2017). 2016 letter to shareholders. July lecture slide 27.

NOW YOU · PAIRS · 3 MINUTES

Would you co-found with your neighbour?

What would you need to know first?

3:00

INPUT 3 OF 4 · COMMIT TO IT · THE ANSWERS

Commit to it: test the fit, then write it down

1

Where do you find co-founders?

Like customers, with a pipeline. Choose people you have seen work

2

How do you test the fit?

Under load, not over coffee. Use the days until next time as a trial

3

What do you settle before you commit?

The hard questions, roles before shares, and who owns which decision

Keep it honest: feedback and candor

You will disagree, so learn to give and take feedback in four moves.

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INPUT 4 OF 4 · KEEP IT HONEST · THREE QUESTIONS

How do you disagree well?

1

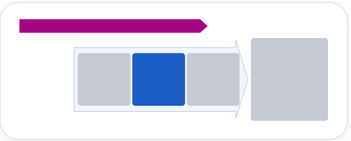
Why does feedback so often backfire?

2

How do you give it?

3

How do you take it?

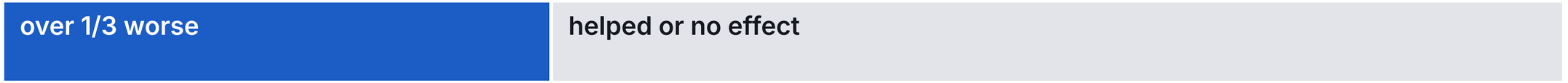


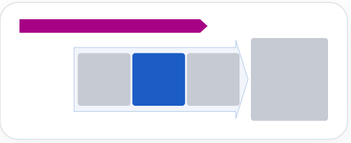
WHY IT MATTERS

Over a third of feedback makes things worse

Aim at the task, not the person

Feedback interventions · 607 effects, 23,663 observations





GIVING FEEDBACK · CREATING THE MESSAGE

Give feedback in four moves

Situation, behaviour, impact, the change you ask for

To your co-founder, after the pitch

Situation
When and where

In yesterday's investor pitch,

Behaviour
Only what you saw

you showed numbers on slide 10 that didn't match our model.

Impact
On you, on the company

Two investors asked about it, and we lost ten minutes.

Change
What you ask for

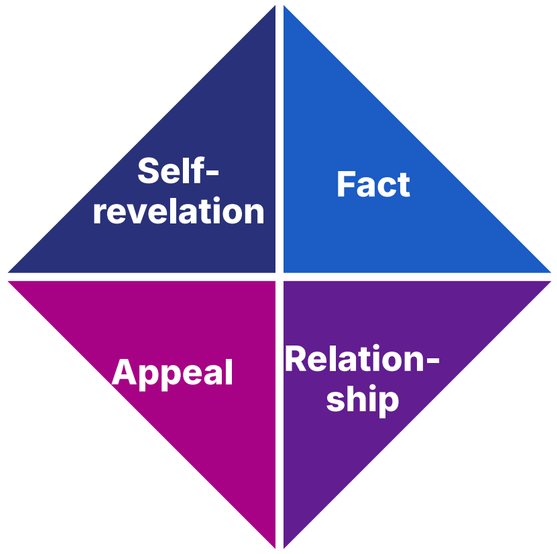
Next time, can we check the numbers together the day before?

Adapted from the DESC script of Bower, S. A., & Bower, G. H. (1976). *Asserting yourself*. Addison-Wesley. The message is a made-up example.

RECEIVING FEEDBACK · DECODING THE MESSAGE

Every message has four sides

Hear the appeal, not only the facts



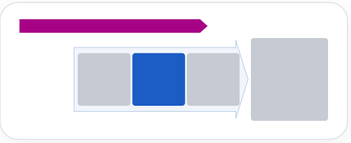
Sender **Receiver**

Fact
“The financial projections in the pitch were wrong.”

Self-revelation
“I'm worried we won't convince investors.”

Relationship
“As your co-founder, I want to help.”

Appeal
“Let's fix the projections together.”



RADICAL CANDOR

Care personally and challenge directly

We want to grow through direct feedback

CARE PERSONALLY

Ruinous Empathy
Care personally but don't challenge directly

Radical Candor
Care personally and challenge directly

SILENCE — CHALLENGE DIRECTLY

Manipulative Insincerity
Neither care nor challenge directly

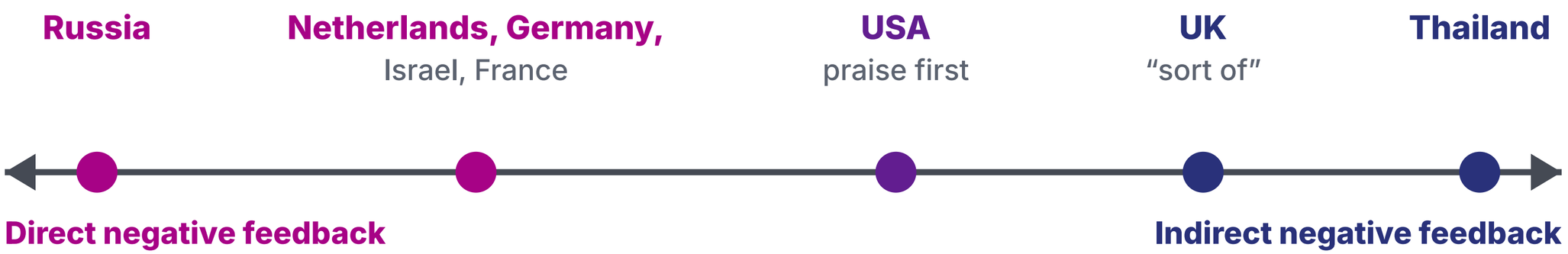
Obnoxious Aggression
Challenge directly but don't care personally

DON'T CARE AT ALL

CULTURE

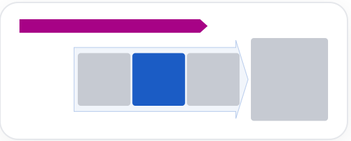
How direct is too direct depends on culture

Ask your co-founder how they like feedback



Upgraders: “absolutely”, “totally” **Downgraders: “a little bit”**

FRAMEWORK Zones after Meyer, E. (2014). *The culture map*. PublicAffairs. Meyer, E. (2015). Giving negative feedback across cultures. INSEAD Knowledge. Positions approximate.



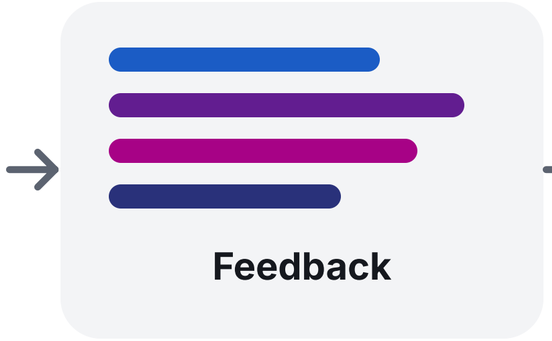
THE 4A CHEAT SHEET FOR CANDOR

Give to help. Receive to learn

You give

Aim to assist
Help them, not your ego

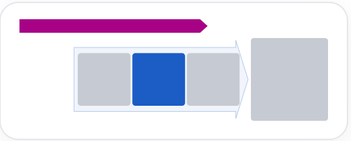
Actionable
Say what to do differently



They receive

Appreciate
Thank them, then listen

Accept or discard
Your call, after thinking



NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

Write one feedback in four moves

Situation — When and where?

Behaviour — What did you see?

Impact — What did it cause?

Change — What do you ask for?

3:00

OUTPUT

Four lines, ready to give

INPUT 4 OF 4 · KEEP IT HONEST · THE ANSWERS

Keep it honest: care and challenge

1

Why does feedback so often backfire?

Over a third makes things worse. Aim at the task, not the person

2

How do you give it?

In four moves: situation, behaviour, impact, the change you ask for

3

How do you take it?

Hear the appeal, not only the facts. Thank them, then decide

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

Wrap-up and check-out

Look back at your bars and your mates, reflect, and take the homework with you.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Aim it: startup or small business~~

04 ~~Staff it: why teams matter~~

05 ~~Commit to it: a long-term relationship~~

06 ~~Keep it honest: feedback and candor~~

07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

08 Workshop: find your team and test the fit

09 Case discussion

RECAP · WHERE WE ARE

Pillar 2 done. Next, discover a problem

The next three sessions take pillar 3

✓ **You are trained** ✓ **Done today** **Next three sessions** **By Finding ideas (M02)**

Pillar 1

Learn what it takes

How do I do it?

This course trains you

Pillar 2

Find a team

Who will be my mates?

Your agreement

Pillar 3

Discover a problem

- **Finding ideas (M02)**
- **Problem space (M03)**
- **Validating problems (M04)**

Outcomes

Team committed
for full-time work

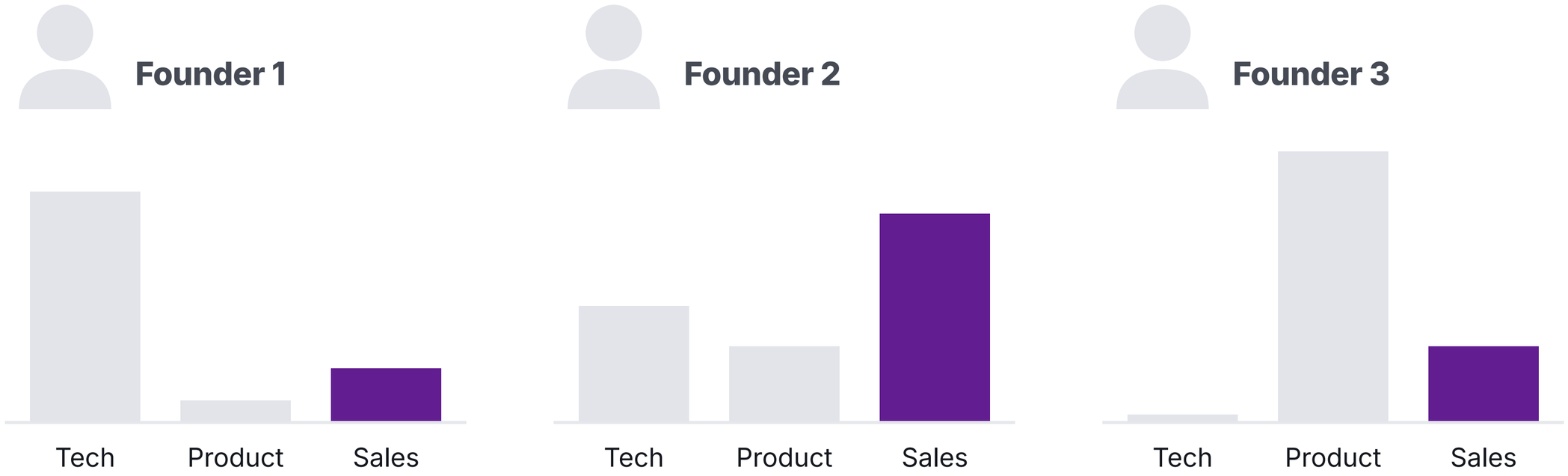
All necessary
disciplines covered

Agreement on the hard and
soft facts about funding

Agreement on one
problem space

RECAP · CORNERSTONE

Who builds, who sells, what's missing?



ILLUSTRATIVE Founder skill bars.

REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

What could you apply?



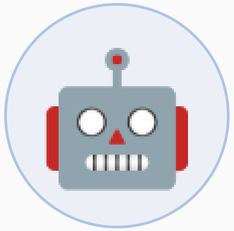
What could you apply?



What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

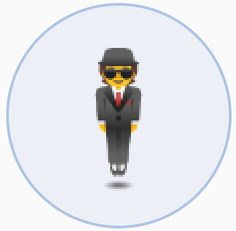
Man vs. machine



Where did AI actually help you?



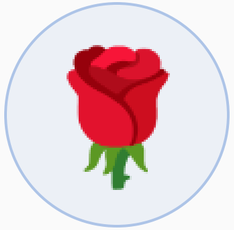
Where was your genius needed?



What are your best hacks to share?

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

Rose, thorn, bud



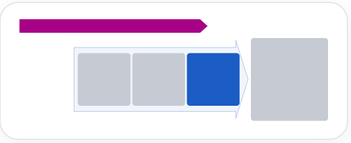
What was the breakthrough today?



What was the hardest part today?



What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?



HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Hold 10 conversations per student in your team's shared problem space, each with a named person and one verbatim quote, and end the week with a team agreement every founder confirmed after your end-of-week feedback round.

10 each

The learning floor is 5 conversations per student and the confirmed agreement.

No kill line in Team foundations. Your review date is in the Team sheet.

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

Two jobs until next time, the team and the talks

THE TEAM

USE THE WEEK AS YOUR TRIAL

Fit shows under load, not over coffee

- → Answer the full Co-Founder Matchmaking Assessment alone, then talk through every gap
- → Hold at least two talks with a co-founder listening, then swap
- → Two builders and nobody selling? Give selling an owner by your midweek day, or recruit one
- → Hold your feedback round at the end of the week
- → Then update and confirm the agreement

Output the confirmed agreement

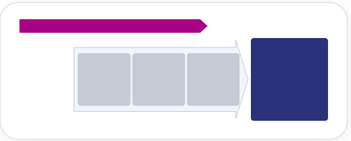
THE TALKS

FIND YOUR PEOPLE, STAY IN THE PROBLEM

Ten conversations per student in your shared problem space

- → Start with Kickoff (M00) contacts and their intros, people you see daily and where the work happens
- → Review sites and AI deep research show where they complain
- → Ask about the last time it happened and what it cost. Don't pitch. Log every problem, unranked
- → Record with the consent sentence in Legal Basics
- → Get a blind second opinion. Give an AI your raw notes, minus personal data and your favourite idea

Output talks in the Interview Log



HOMEWORK · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

What good looks like by Finding ideas (M02)

Made-up example, the same team as in the workshop

	GOOD	WEAK
Agreement	“Selling: the designer owns it. Ties: the engineer decides by Friday.”	“We decide everything together.”
Talks	“10 named lab managers, quoted. 4 lose over 3 hours a week on orders.”	“15 chats with friends.”

ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up example from the Team (M01) homework, "What you come back with".

NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 4 MINUTES

Start your group today

! YOUR GROUP

Name the teams, set the first goal

You leave with a date and a goal that passes the test.

→ **List** 2 to 6 other teams at your pace, here or outside
→ **Pick** a date for the first meeting, two weeks from now
→ **Write** your first goal: one sentence, a number, a date
→ **Test** it with the team next to you: learning, revenue, lasting?

Output Group list, date, one tested goal

Minutes 4

4:00

Sources in this deck

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Y Combinator. Co-Founder Matching. ycombinator.com/cofounder-matching, as of October 2026.

See you next time, as a team!

MODULE 01 · WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

Workshop: Find your team and test the fit

Pitch your problem, find your people, test the fit and give your first feedback.

Team & Foundations · Why do the best teams beat the best ideas?

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Aim it: startup or small business**

04 **Staff it: why teams matter**

05 **Commit to it: a long-term relationship**

06 **Keep it honest: feedback and candor**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 **Workshop: find your team and test the fit**

09 Case discussion



WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

Pitch your problem, find your people

1 STEP 1 · 30 MIN

PITCH YOUR PROBLEM, FIND YOUR PEOPLE

Know your own answers, then meet your people

→ 10 min alone: rate tech, product, sales 1 to 10, plus joy
→ Six questions: hours, savings, ambition, role, problem, leaving
→ 10 min: no team? One-minute pitch and the skill you miss
→ Existing teams pitch only their gap
→ 10 min: compare hours, money, ambition first. Teams of 2 to 4

Output Skill bars, six answers, a team

Minutes 30

30:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 · ALONE, 10 MINUTES

Six questions, alone first

1 Hours

How many hours a week can you give, now and in six months?

2 Savings

How many months can you live on your savings?

3 Ambition

Startup, growing customers fast, or small business, growing profit? How big should this get?

4 Role

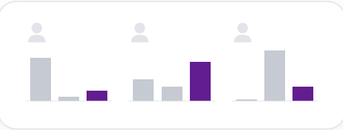
Which role do you want, and what will you never do?

5 Problem

Which problem would you work on for five years?

6 Leaving

When should a co-founder leave, and what happens to their shares?



WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

Test the fit before you commit

2 STEP 2 · 35 MIN

TEST THE FIT BEFORE YOU COMMIT

Find the dealbreakers now, while they are cheap

→ 10 min: answers side by side. Agree, talk, or dealbreaker?
→ 5 min: skill bars side by side. Who builds, who sells?
→ Name the gap. Learn, recruit or pay?
→ 10 min: startup or small business, how far, and why
→ 10 min: draft agreement in the Toolkit's Team sheet

Output Dealbreakers named, a draft agreement

Minutes 35

35:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

First feedback, then commit

3 STEP 3 · 25 MIN

FIRST FEEDBACK, THEN COMMIT

Give feedback while it is cheap, then start the week

→ 10 min: round the circle, one piece of feedback each
→ Situation, behaviour, impact, the change you ask for
→ The receiver says "thank you" and asks one question
→ 10 min: floor or full bar, midweek day
→ 5 min: book first talks before you leave

Output Feedback held, targets, first talks booked

Minutes 25

25:00

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

No problem space from Kickoff (M00)? Pitch one from your own life or work.

1 minute, one problem

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Hold 10 conversations per student in your team's shared problem space, each with a named person and one verbatim quote, and end the week with a team agreement every founder confirmed after your end-of-week feedback round.

10 each

The learning floor is 5 conversations per student and the confirmed agreement.

No kill line in Team foundations. Your review date is in the Team sheet.

See you next time, as a team!

MODULE 01 · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

Case discussion: ProGlove

Sit in Thomas Kirchner's chair in autumn 2018 and decide who should run ProGlove next.

Team & Foundations · Why do the best teams beat the best ideas?

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 Aim it: startup or small business

04 Staff it: why teams matter

05 Commit to it: a long-term relationship

06 Keep it honest: feedback and candor

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find your team and test the fit

09 Case discussion

CASE · PROGLOVE, MUNICH, AUTUMN 2018 · VOTE 1 OF 2

Who should run ProGlove next?

OPTION A

The founders keep the chief executive's role, with König advising

OPTION B

Hand the chief executive's role to an experienced outsider

Vote A or B, one hand each, no abstentions. Keep your reason to one piece of evidence from the case.

CASE · TIMELINE TO OCTOBER 2018

From a contest to a company that hires

2014	Third place in Intel's “Make it Wearable” contest
4 February 2015	Company entered in the commercial register in Munich
11 November 2015	Workaround GmbH, Kirchner the only managing director
May 2016	First financing round, USD 2.2 million, led by Intel Capital
October 2016	MARK launched in Europe
September 2017	About 150 customers, about 60 people (Kirchner, recording)
January 2018	Pilot tests in the USA and Canada
April 2018	Second round, EUR 5.5 million. EUR 7.7 million from outside investors in total
April and May 2018	51 openings on the careers pages
23 August 2018	Girardet and Bönisch registered as managing directors beside Kirchner
14 September 2018	Index Trigger launched, Kirchner quoted as chief executive
Autumn 2018	König, former chief executive of TeamViewer, advising the founders (start not dated)

DATA Team (M01) case: ProGlove, from public sources (2026-10-19). Exhibit 1 and the case opening.



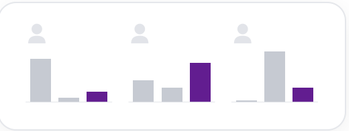
CASE · EXHIBIT 2, CONDENSED

Who did what in 2018? You fill the bars

Documented in one colour, your guess in another

PERSON	ROLE IN 2018	TECH	PRODUCT	SALES
Thomas Kirchner	Co-founder, chief executive			
Jonas Girardet	Co-founder, COO			
Paul Günther	Co-founder, product engineer			
Alexander Grots	Co-founder, consultant			
Manuel Bönisch	Managing director from 23 August 2018			
Andreas König	Advisor on the sales side (Kirchner, 2022) or chairman of the board (Kirchner, 2025)			

DATA Team (M01) case: ProGlove, from public sources (2026-10-19). Exhibit 2. König's start is not documented. (2025) marks the panel published in 2025.



CASE · EXHIBIT 4 · CAREERS PAGES, APRIL AND MAY 2018

What was ProGlove hiring for in spring 2018?

PAGE AND TEAM	FULL TIME	INTERNSHIP
Business (21 May 2018)	**16**	**11**
Marketing, direct and indirect sales, after sales, sales operations	13	9
People and culture, finance	3	2
Development (18 May 2018)	**11**	**5**
Supply chain and production (15 April 2018)	**6**	**2**
All three pages	**33**	**18**

DATA Compiled by the case writer from ProGlove's careers pages as captured by the Internet Archive. Team (M01) case: ProGlove, from public sources (2026-10-19).



CASE · BOARD PLAN · 30 MINUTES

Learn, recruit or pay. Who decides what the day after?

Skill and appetite map

Five people and König

Tech, product, sales

A bar and a note on appetite

Documented vs. guessed

Route table

	Learn	Recruit	Pay
Evidence for			
Evidence against			
Who decides what, day after			
What each founder does			

Two votes

Before: A __ B __

After: A __ B __

Who moved, and why?

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

Same question. Who moved, and why?

OPTION A

The founders keep the chief executive's role, with König advising

OPTION B

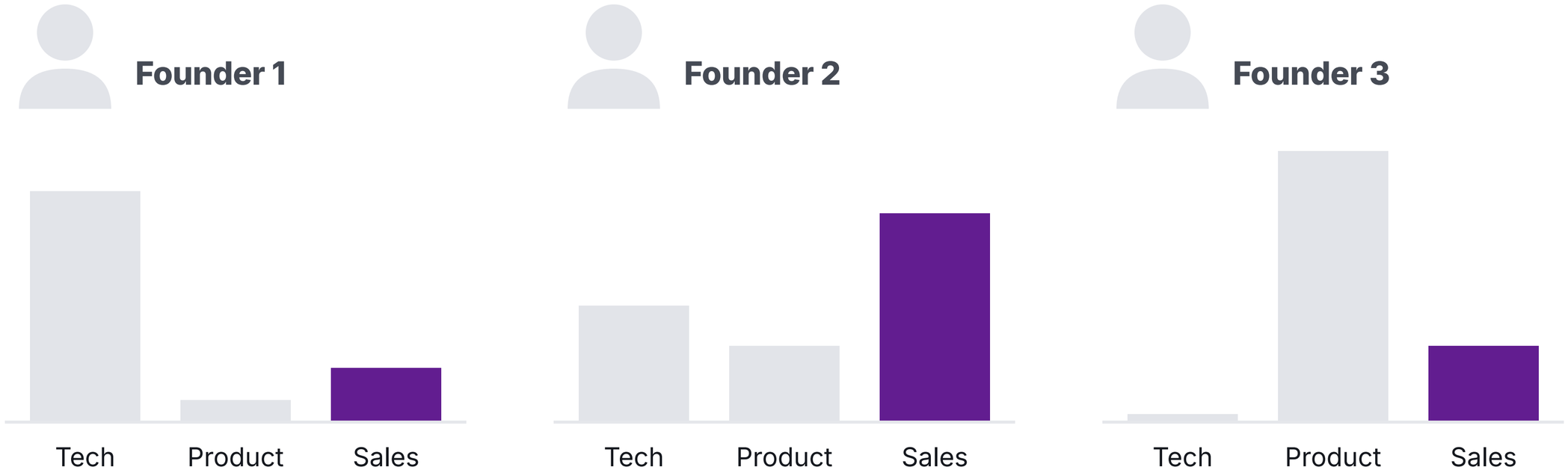
Hand the chief executive's role to an experienced outsider

Vote A or B, one hand each, no abstentions. Keep your reason to one piece of evidence from the case.

CASE · BRIDGE

Now your team's gap

Lay your skill bars side by side. Who builds, who sells, which gap stops you? Learn, recruit or pay to close it.



ILLUSTRATIVE Founder skill bars. Bridge into workshop step 2, or without the workshop the Team sheet line “Our gap and how we close it”.

See you next time, as a team!